

Poultry



and Poultry Raising



(Pathfinder Honor)

1. Meaning of Poultry

Poultry refers to domesticated birds that are kept by humans mainly for the production of eggs, meat, feathers, and income. Common poultry birds include chickens, ducks, turkeys, geese, and quail.

2. Importance of Poultry Keeping

Provides protein-rich food such as eggs and meat

Source of income and employment

Requires little space and low starting capital

Supplies manure for crop farming

Improves household nutrition and food security

3. Egg-Laying and Meat-Producing Qualities of Poultry Breeds

Plymouth Rock

This is a dual-purpose breed used for both eggs and meat. It lays brown eggs, is hardy, calm, and easy to manage, making it suitable for beginners.

Wyandotte

Wyandottes are dual-purpose birds that lay brown eggs. They are good winter layers and are known for their attractive feather patterns.

Rhode Island Red

This breed is an excellent brown egg layer and also produces good quality meat. It is hardy and adapts well to different environments.

Orpington

Orpingtons are heavy-bodied birds mainly raised for meat. They are fair egg layers, produce brown eggs, and are broody with good mothering ability.

Leghorn

Leghorns are excellent white egg layers. They have light bodies, making them poor meat producers, but they are very efficient in feed conversion.

Peking Duck

Peking ducks are raised mainly for meat. They grow fast and have white feathers with a yellow beak and orange legs.

Mammoth Bronze Turkey

This turkey breed is very large and raised mainly for meat. It grows slowly but produces a large carcass.

White Holland Turkey

White Holland turkeys are raised for meat. Their white feathers make the carcass look clean after processing.

Toulouse Goose

This is a heavy goose breed raised for meat and fat production. It has a calm temperament and grows large.

4. Purpose of Poultry Equipment and Structures

Incubators

Incubators are used to hatch eggs artificially. They control temperature, humidity, ventilation, and egg turning to allow embryos to develop properly.

Hovers (Brooders)

Hovers provide warmth to young chicks after hatching. They replace the heat normally provided by a mother hen.

Sanitary Fowl Houses

These houses protect birds from bad weather and predators. They also help reduce the spread of diseases.

Coops

Coops provide shelter for adult birds. They contain nesting boxes for egg laying and roosting areas for resting.

Runs

Runs are fenced outdoor areas that allow birds to exercise. They reduce stress, boredom, and cannibalism.

5. Candling of Eggs

Candling is the process of examining eggs using a bright light to see inside the egg.

Purpose of Candling

To identify fertile and infertile eggs

To detect cracked, rotten, or bad eggs

To observe embryo development

To improve hatching success

6. Feeding Program for Domestic Fowl

Chick Stage (0–6 weeks)

Chicks are fed chick starter mash, which is high in protein (about 18–22%) to support fast growth.

Grower Stage (6–18 weeks)

Grower mash is given at this stage. It contains moderate protein to support steady development.

Layer or Breeder Stage

Layer mash is fed to laying birds. It is rich in calcium to help form strong eggshells.

7. Incubation Requirements

Incubation is the process of hatching eggs using an incubator under controlled conditions.

Chicken eggs require a temperature of about 37.5°C, humidity of 55–60%, and hatch in about 21 days.

Duck eggs hatch in about 28 days at 37.5°C with 60–65% humidity.

Goose eggs hatch in about 30 days at around 37.2°C with higher humidity.

Quail eggs hatch in about 17–18 days at 37.5°C.

Turkey eggs hatch in about 28 days at 37.5°C with moderate humidity.

8. Raising Poultry After Hatching

After hatching, chicks should be kept warm, dry, and protected. Clean water and proper feed must be provided. Vaccination against common diseases is important, and cleanliness must be maintained at all times.

9. Identification of Poultry Breeds (Skill Level 2)

Chickens

Plymouth Rock: black and white barred feathers

Wyandotte: rounded body with a rose comb

Rhode Island Red: deep red feathers

Orpington: fluffy body and soft feathers

Leghorn: white body with a large comb

Ducks

Peking duck: white feathers and orange legs

Turkeys

Mammoth Bronze

White Holland

Bourbon Red

Geese

Toulouse

Emden

Chinese

10. Poultry Farm Visit Report (Guide)

When visiting a poultry farm, observe the types of birds kept, housing systems used, feeding methods, and disease control practices.

11. Conclusion

Poultry and poultry raising are important agricultural activities that provide food, income, and employment. With proper management, feeding, housing, and health care, poultry farming can be very productive and sustainable.